

Dignity for all when passing on

If **living** with **dignity** **is** a basic human **aspiration**, dying with dignity is no less important. And, yet, **conversations** around **euthanasia** - particularly the right to make end-of-life choices - **remain cloaked** in **discomfort**. That may be slowly changing. Two recent **developments point to** a shift in public and institutional thinking: launch of a **dedicated** living will clinic at a Mumbai hospital, and Britain's Parliament voting to **legalise assisted** dying for **terminally-ill** patients.

In India, a living will was first given legal **backing** in the 2018 Supreme Court judgment in 'Common Cause vs Union of India', which **reaffirmed** the right to die with dignity under Article 21. It was built on the court's earlier **recognition** of **passive** euthanasia in the 2011 Aruna Shanbaug case. **A living will** - formally, 'advance medical **directive**' - **allows** individuals to **document** their preferences for **life-sustaining** treatment should they become **incapacitated**.



Still, there is a gap between legal recognition and implementation. The Mumbai hospital's initiative is a welcome attempt to **bridge that divide**. Doctors say many patients have little understanding of what ICU care **entails** until they're **confronted** with **specifics** - ventilators, **invasive** procedures and indefinite suffering. **Facilitated** conversations can help persons make better-informed decisions. In 2023, **the apex court** eased the process for passive euthanasia by simplifying earlier guidelines. Now, the **onus** is on the state, medical professionals and institutions to make these choices accessible and understandable. A **dignified** death should not be a **privilege**. It's a right, one that must be supported with clear laws, **empathetic** systems and public awareness. **Encouraging** living wills **is** a **critical** step in that direction. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

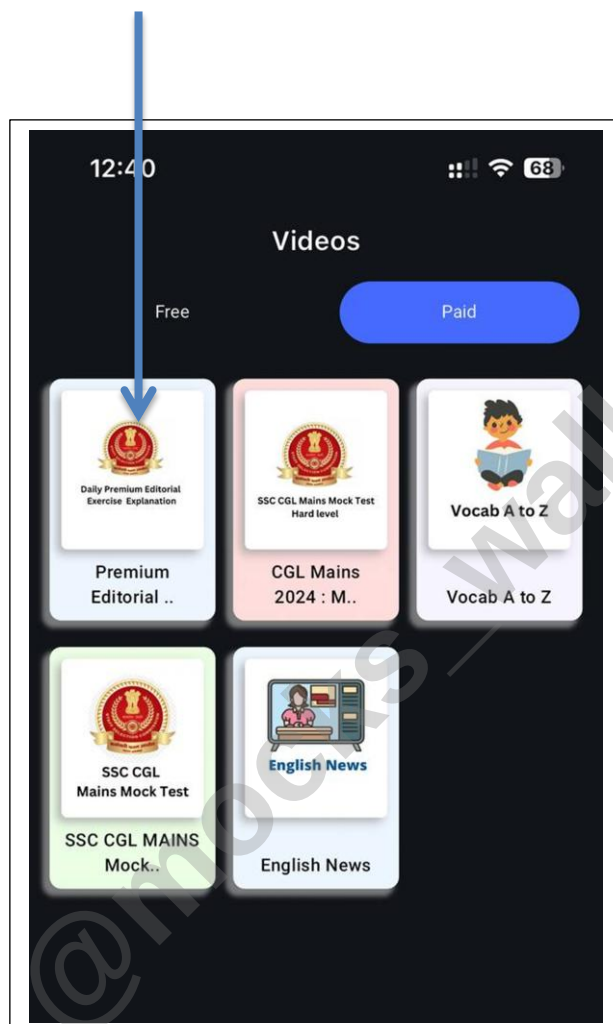
1. **Dignity** (noun) – Self-respect, honour, decency, nobility, worth गरिमा
2. **Pass on** (phrasal verb) – Die, depart, expire, perish, leave दुनिया छोड़ना
3. **Aspiration** (noun) – Ambition, desire, goal, aim, dream आकांक्षा
4. **Euthanasia** (noun) – the painless killing of a patient suffering from an incurable and painful disease or in an irreversible coma. इच्छामृत्यु
5. **Cloak** (verb) – Cover, conceal, mask, hide, shroud छिपाना
6. **Discomfort** (noun) – Unease, distress, awkwardness, uneasiness, inconvenience असहजता
7. **Development** (noun) – Progress, advancement, event, evolution, change घटना
8. **Point to** (phrasal verb) – Indicate, suggest, show, highlight, reveal संकेत करना
9. **Dedicated** (adjective) – Specialized, devoted, committed, focused, exclusive समर्पित
10. **Legalise** (verb) – Authorize, legitimate, decriminalize, sanction, permit वैध करना
11. **Assisted** (adjective) – Supported, aided, helped, facilitated, backed सहायक
12. **Terminally-ill** (adjective) – an illness that cannot be cured and is expected to eventually lead to death अंतिम चरण के रोगी
13. **Backing** (noun) – Support, endorsement, approval, assistance, patronage समर्थन
14. **Reaffirm** (verb) – Restate, confirm, assert again, emphasize, reiterate फिर से पुष्टि करना
15. **Recognition** (noun) – Acceptance, acknowledgment, awareness, appreciation, validation मान्यता
16. **Passive** (adjective) – Inactive, non-active, submissive, unresisting, non-intervening निष्क्रिय
17. **Living Will** (noun) – a written document in which a person says what type of medical treatment they would like if they become so ill that they are unable to make decisions. वसीयत
18. **Directive** (noun) – Order, instruction, command, guideline, mandate निर्देश
19. **Document** (verb) – Record, write down, register, log, chronicle दस्तावेज़ बनाना

20. **Life-sustaining** (adjective) – Vital, essential for survival, preserving life, supportive, prolonging जीवन बनाए रखने वाला
21. **Incapacitated** (adjective) – Disabled, powerless, helpless, unfit, debilitated अक्षम
22. **Bridge the divide** (phrase) – Close the gap, bring together, reconcile, connect, unite दूरी कम करना
23. **Entail** (verb) – Involve, require, necessitate, demand, include शामिल होना
24. **Confront** (verb) – Face, encounter, deal with, meet, tackle सामना करना
25. **Specific** (noun) – Detail, particular, fact, item, exact information विशेष विवरण
26. **Invasive Procedure** (noun) – A medical procedure that invades (enters) the body, usually by cutting or puncturing the skin or by inserting instruments into the body.
27. **Facilitated** (adjective) – Assisted, enabled, made easier, supported, helped सुविधाजनक बनाया गया
28. **The apex court** (noun) – Supreme Court, highest court, top judicial body, constitutional court सर्वोच्च न्यायालय
29. **Onus** (noun) – Responsibility, duty, burden, obligation, charge जिम्मेदारी
30. **Dignified** (adjective) – Respectable, noble, stately, honourable, proper गरिमामय
31. **Privilege** (noun) – Advantage, special right, benefit, prerogative, entitlement विशेषाधिकार
32. **Empathetic** (adjective) – Compassionate, understanding, sensitive, caring, kind सहानुभूति रखने वाला
33. **Critical** (adjective) – Crucial, essential, vital, important, decisive महत्वपूर्ण

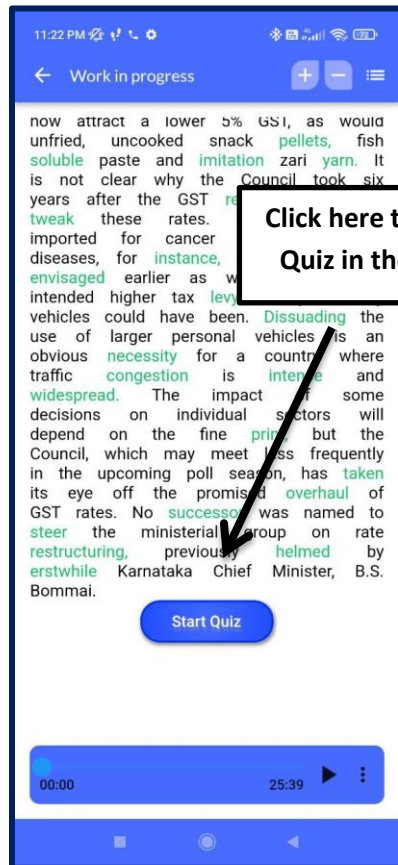
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Dignity in Death Matters** – Just like living with dignity, dying with dignity is an essential human aspiration.
2. **Discomfort Around Euthanasia** – Discussions on euthanasia and end-of-life choices remain uncomfortable in society.
3. **Signs of Change** – Two recent events suggest changing attitudes: a living will clinic in Mumbai and Britain's Parliament voting to legalize assisted dying for terminal patients.
4. **Legal Recognition in India** – India's Supreme Court backed living wills in the 2018 'Common Cause vs Union of India' judgment.
5. **Passive Euthanasia Precedent** – This built on the 2011 Aruna Shanbaug case, where passive euthanasia was recognized.
6. **Living Will Defined** – A living will, or advance medical directive, lets people state their treatment preferences if they become incapacitated.
7. **Gap in Implementation** – Despite legal support, practical implementation of living wills remains inadequate.
8. **Mumbai Hospital Initiative** – A Mumbai hospital's living will clinic aims to make end-of-life choices more accessible.
9. **Patients Lack Awareness** – Many patients don't fully understand what intensive care involves until faced with it directly.
10. **Facilitated Conversations** – Discussing end-of-life care beforehand helps patients make informed decisions.
11. **SC's 2023 Guidelines** – The Supreme Court simplified the procedure for passive euthanasia in 2023, making it easier to implement.
12. **State's Responsibility** – Governments and healthcare providers must now ensure these choices are practically available.
13. **Need for Empathetic Systems** – Supportive and compassionate systems are crucial for dignified end-of-life care.
14. **Clear Laws Essential** – Clear legal frameworks are needed to guarantee people's right to a dignified death.
15. **Public Awareness Critical** – Promoting living wills and raising awareness are vital steps toward normalizing end-of-life choices.

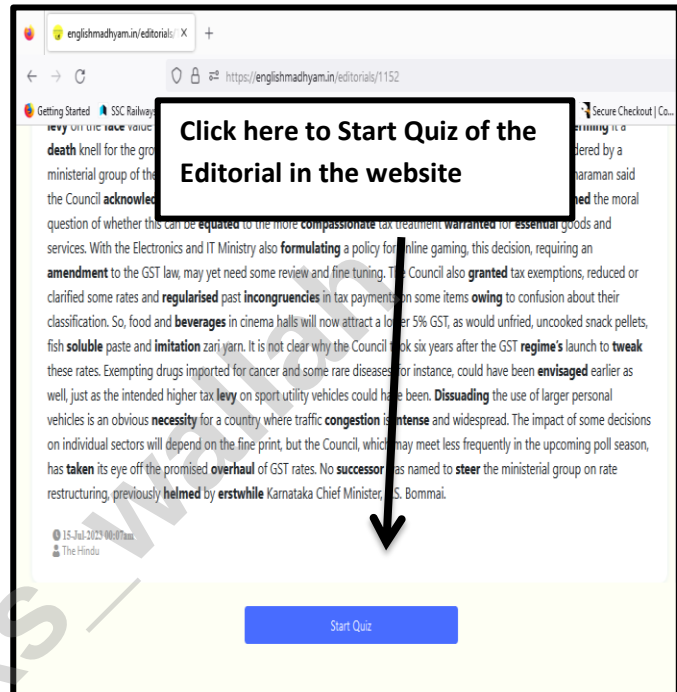
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



Click here to Start Quiz in the App



Click here to Start Quiz of the Editorial in the website

[Click here to download App](#)

[Click here to visit website](#)



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam